HealthyMart

FSSAI Regulatory Compliance Knowledge Base

Reference corpus for the AI-powered Regulatory Compliance RAG engine

Important note on currency of information: This document compiles FSSAI's core regulatory framework (Act, Rules, Regulations) and known guidance as of the source's training data (through Jan 2026). FSSAI issues circulars and amendments frequently. Before production use, verify against the live sources at **fssai.gov.in** → Legal Reference → Acts & Rules / Notifications, and rebuild this document on a recurring schedule (the compliance engine's own 'continuous scrape' layer should be the system of record; this PDF is a strong seed/base layer for the RAG index.)

Prepared as a RAG source document — not a substitute for legal counsel or official FSSAI advisories.

1. Purpose of This Document

This document is designed to be ingested into HealthyMart's FSSAI Regulatory Compliance RAG engine as a foundational knowledge base. It summarizes the key Acts, Rules, and Regulations that govern food business operators (FBOs) in India, with specific attention to labelling, packaging, additives, licensing, and e-commerce/quick-commerce obligations — the areas most relevant to a clean-label quick-commerce marketplace. Each section is written in self-contained chunks suitable for retrieval, with plain-language summaries alongside the formal regulatory reference so the RAG can answer both compliance-officer and seller-facing queries.

2. Legal Framework Overview

2.1 Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 (FSS Act)

The parent legislation establishing the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) as the apex regulator. It consolidates earlier fragmented laws (PFA, Fruit Products Order, Meat Food Products Order, Vegetable Oil Products Order, Edible Oils Packaging Order, Solvent Extracted Oil Order, Milk and Milk Products Order, and related sugar/food orders) into a single statute covering licensing, standard-setting, enforcement, and penalties.

2.2 Food Safety and Standards Rules, 2011 (FSS Rules)

Procedural rules under the Act — covering the constitution of FSSAI, Central Advisory Committee, scientific panels, and adjudication procedures.

2.3 Food Safety and Standards Regulations (multiple, notified 2011 onward)

A family of regulations issued under the Act. The ones most relevant to a quick-commerce clean-label platform are detailed in Sections 4–10 below.

3. Licensing & Registration

3.1 Categories of FSSAI Registration/License

- **Basic Registration (FSSAI Registration):** For petty food businesses with annual turnover up to ■12 lakh (e.g., small manufacturers, home-based FBOs, petty retailers, hawkers). Simple registration, Form A.
- **State License:** For medium-sized FBOs with annual turnover between ■12 lakh and ■20 crore, or specific categories (e.g., storage, transport above certain capacity) regardless of turnover. Issued by the State Food Safety Commissioner, Form B.
- **Central License:** For large FBOs with turnover above ■20 crore, importers, businesses operating in more than one state, e-commerce food business operators (100% e-commerce/quick-commerce platforms typically require Central License), 5-star hotels, railways/airport catering, and large storage/manufacturing units.

3.2 Key Licensing Points for a Quick-Commerce Marketplace

- The platform itself (as an FBO facilitating sale of food, per FSS (Licensing and Registration) Regulations, 2011, as amended) generally needs a Central FSSAI License for its e-commerce operations.

- Every dark store / fulfillment center / warehouse that stores or repacks food needs its own valid FSSAI license/registration tied to that physical address — licenses are not transferable across premises.
- Every seller/brand listed on the marketplace must hold a valid, unexpired FSSAI license or registration appropriate to their turnover and activity (manufacturer, repacker, or trader).
- Licenses must be renewed before expiry (renewal window: 30 days to 120 days before expiry, depending on license type); operating on an expired license is a compliance violation and grounds for delisting.
- License number must be displayed on the FBO's premises and printed on all products sold (see Section 4).

4. Food Safety and Standards (Labelling and Display) Regulations, 2020

This is the single most operationally important regulation for a quick-commerce catalog, since almost every product-page compliance check maps back to it.

4.1 Mandatory Label Elements

- Name of food / product name as prescribed or generic descriptive name
- List of ingredients in descending order of composition by weight/volume, including compound ingredients
- Declaration of food additives with class name and INS (International Numbering System) number
- Nutritional information per 100g/100ml or per serving (energy, protein, carbohydrate, total sugar, added sugar, total fat, saturated fat, trans fat, sodium)
- Veg/non-veg symbol (green dot for vegetarian, brown dot for non-vegetarian) — mandatory, prominently placed
- FSSAI logo and license/registration number
- Net quantity in metric units
- Name and complete address of manufacturer/packer/importer/brand owner
- Batch or lot identification number
- Date of manufacture and 'best before' or 'use by' date (as applicable to the product category)
- Country of origin (mandatory for imported foods)
- Instructions for use, where necessary for safe consumption
- Allergen declaration — mandatory for the 8 major allergen categories: cereals containing gluten, crustaceans, eggs, fish, peanuts, soybeans, milk, and tree nuts (‘Contains’ / ‘May contain’ statements)

4.2 Font size & prominence rules

Minimum font size requirements apply based on package surface area (generally 1mm–2mm depending on pack size, per the size-tiered table in the regulation). Declarations must not be obscured, and the name/logo of the FBO cannot be more prominent than the mandatory declarations.

4.3 Restrictions on Claims

- Claims like ‘natural’, ‘fresh’, ‘pure’, ‘100%’, ‘no added preservatives’ have specific conditions attached under the regulation and under the Food Safety and Standards (Advertising and Claims) Regulations, 2018 — they cannot be used loosely on packaging or in marketing copy without meeting the underlying condition.
- Health and nutrition claims (e.g., ‘low fat’, ‘high protein’, ‘no added sugar’, ‘organic’) must satisfy specific threshold values defined in the regulations — a claim engine should validate these against actual declared nutrient values before allowing the claim on a product listing.
- Comparative claims must specify the basis of comparison.
- Misleading claims, deceptive packaging (slack fill), and imitation/deceptive naming of foods are prohibited.

Watch item for RAG updates: A Front-of-Pack Labelling (FOPL) regulation — introducing warning/star rating style indicators for high fat, sugar, and salt (HFSS) products — has been under draft/consultation with FSSAI for several cycles. Confirm current status directly on fssai.gov.in before encoding any FOPL rule as binding, since draft-to-final status changes over time.

5. Food Safety and Standards (Packaging) Regulations, 2018

- Prescribes permitted packaging materials by food category (plastics, metal, glass, paper/paperboard, recycled plastic restrictions for direct food contact).
- Migration limits for substances from packaging material into food.
- Recycled plastic can only be used for packaging if it meets specified safety/migration standards; virgin plastic requirements apply for direct-contact packaging of certain categories.
- Any package alteration (e.g., private-label repacking by the platform) triggers repacker labelling obligations under Section 4.

6. Food Safety and Standards (Food Product Standards and Food Additives) Regulations, 2011

- Defines identity standards for specific product categories (dairy, cereals & cereal products, fats & oils, fruit & vegetable products, sweets & confectionery, spices, beverages, meat & meat products, etc.) — i.e., what a product must legally contain/not contain to be sold under a given name.
- Lists permitted food additives, preservatives, colours, and flavouring agents by category, with maximum permissible limits (in ppm or per Codex GSFA-aligned tables).
- Any additive not listed for a given food category, or used above the permitted limit, renders the product non-compliant — this is a core automatable check for the compliance engine (ingredient-list × category cross-reference).

7. Food Safety and Standards (Prohibition and Restriction on Sales) Regulations, 2011

- Prohibits sale of unsafe, misbranded, sub-standard, or adulterated food.
- Restricts/prohibits sale of specific harmful substances or unapproved ingredients in food.
- Restricts sale of certain high-fat/sugar/salt foods within 50 metres of school premises (relevant if the quick-commerce platform maps delivery/dark-store zones near schools).

- Prohibits use of certain colours/substances (e.g., artificial colours in specific categories where banned) and sale of specified items without proper labelling (e.g., loose/unlabelled edible oil in some contexts).

8. E-Commerce Food Business Operator (FBO) Obligations

FSSAI's Licensing and Registration Regulations, as amended, treat e-commerce FBOs (marketplaces facilitating sale of food, including quick-commerce) as a distinct category with specific duties — directly relevant to HealthyMart's seller-onboarding and catalog logic:

- Must ensure every food business/brand on the platform holds a valid FSSAI license/registration before listing, and must display the FBO's license number on the product page.
- Must ensure listed products meet packaging and labelling requirements applicable to that product before sale — the marketplace carries co-responsibility for what's listed, not just the seller.
- Must maintain traceability records for food handled through its platform/fulfillment network.
- Must ensure temperature control and hygienic conditions during storage and transportation for perishable/temperature-sensitive categories (dairy, meat, ready-to-eat, frozen) — cold-chain compliance under general food safety and hygiene requirements.
- Grievance redressal mechanism for food-safety complaints must be provided to consumers.

9. Hygiene & General Food Safety Requirements

- Food Safety and Standards (Licensing and Registration of Food Businesses) Regulations, 2011 — Schedule 4 prescribes general hygienic and sanitary practices required at manufacturing/storage/sale premises (applicable to dark stores/warehouses).
- FoSTaC (Food Safety Training and Certification) — FSSAI mandates that food businesses have trained Food Safety Supervisors on staff, scaled to business size; relevant for warehouse/dark-store operations handling perishables.
- Temperature logging requirements for cold-chain categories.

10. Compliance Checks Recommended for the RAG-Driven Flagging Engine

Mapping HealthyMart's three automated flags (from the pitch deck) to the underlying regulatory basis:

- **Sellers with non-compliant products** — cross-check: (a) valid & unexpired FSSAI license/registration number format and status, (b) mandatory label fields present (Section 4.1), (c) ingredient list vs. permitted additive list for that food category (Section 6), (d) claim language vs. claim-substantiation rules (Section 4.3).
- **Ingredients that get newly banned/restricted** — diff incoming FSSAI notifications/circulars against the current permitted-additive and prohibited-substance tables (Sections 6–7); flag any live product whose ingredient list intersects with a newly restricted substance.
- **Licences that need renewal** — track license expiry dates per seller/premises against the 30–120 day renewal window (Section 3.2); auto-flag sellers approaching or past expiry.

11. Suggested RAG Ingestion Structure

For best retrieval quality, chunk this corpus by regulation-and-sub-topic (roughly one chunk per numbered sub-section above, 200–500 tokens each) rather than by page, and tag each chunk with metadata: *regulation_name, section_number, effective_date, applies_to (manufacturer/repacker/e-commerce/all), category (labelling/packaging/additives/licensing/hygiene)*. This lets the compliance engine filter retrieval by the specific check it's running (e.g., only 'labelling' chunks when validating a new product listing) instead of searching the whole corpus every time.

12. Sources to Monitor for Ongoing Updates

- fssai.gov.in → 'Legal Reference' → Acts, Rules & Regulations (consolidated, official text)
- fssai.gov.in → 'Notifications' and 'Orders/Circulars' (for amendments and new guidance between formal regulation revisions)
- FSSAI's Food Safety Compliance System (FoSCoS) portal — for license/registration status verification (useful if HealthyMart wants to build a live license-validation API check rather than relying solely on the RAG)
- State Food Safety Commissionerate notifications, for any state-specific add-ons

Recommended cadence: re-scrape/re-index Sections 12's sources at least monthly, and treat this static PDF as the versioned 'base layer' snapshot (e.g., v1 — Aug 2026) with newer circulars layered on top as separate, dated chunks rather than edits to this file, so the RAG can prioritize recency when rules conflict.